

Grande Valse Brillante

An Analysis of the Waltz

Op. 18

Frederick Chopin

This waltz is in what I would consider to be a Quasi-Sonata Form. It isn't your typical Sonata Form, but it is quite similar to Sonata Form. The first A section you could consider to be the Exposition, the B section and Digression, you could consider both to be part of the Development section, and the second A section, you could consider to be the Recapitulation.

Or you could just say that the waltz is in an atypical Ternary Form and leave it at that. Either way you look at it, it isn't in a typical form for the genre. I personally would describe this as a Quasi-Sonata Form though, because of the significance of each section and each theme in each section, including the Coda.

First Theme

Parallel Period - measures 5-21

Phrase A - measures 5-12 - Sentence form

Subphrase a - measures 5-8 - Sentential Presentation

A Section

$\text{♩} = 220$

f Motivic buildup to first theme

ff *p*

Eb: V

$\text{Red. } V^7$ * $\text{Red. } I$ * $\text{Red. } V^7$ * $\text{Red. } V^7/IV$ * $\text{Red. } vii^{07}/ii$ $\text{Red. } ii_4^9$

Phrase A' - measures 13-21 - Sentence form

Subphrase a - measures 13-16 - Sentential Presentation

10

Subphrase b - measures 8-12 - Continuation

IAC

f *ff* *mf*

$\text{Red. } 7_4^6$ * $\text{Red. } V_6^7$ * $\text{Red. } I^{6-5}$ $\text{Red. } V^7$ * $\text{Red. } I$ * $\text{Red. } V^7$ * $\text{Red. } V^7/IV$ * $\text{Red. } vii^{07}/ii$ $\text{Red. } ii_4^9$

1. 2.

Second Theme

Parallel Period - Measures 21-37

Phrase A - Measures 21-29 - Sentence Form

Subphrase a - measures 21-25 - Sentential Presentation

18

Subphrase b - measures 16-21 - Continuation

p PAC Motive

Ab: $\text{Red. } 7_4^6$ * $\text{Red. } V_6^7$ * $\text{Red. } I$ $\text{Red. } vii^{07} I$ $\text{Red. } vii^{07}/V$

25 Subphrase b - measures 25-29 - Continuation

Subphrase a - measures 30-33 - Sentential Presentation

I vii°7/V I₄ V⁷ I First Theme

First Theme
Parallel Period - measures 32-41
Phrase A - measures 38-45 - Sentential
Subphrase a - measures 38-41 - Sentential Phrase

32 Subphrase b - measures 33-37 - Continuation

viio⁷/V I viio⁷/V I^b V⁷ I [E^b]:V⁷ Ped. V⁷ *

39

Subphrase a - measures 46-49 - Sentimental

Subphrase b - measures 41-45 - Continuation

ff *p* IAC

I Red. V^7 Red. V^7/IV $\text{vii}^{\text{o}7}/\text{ii}$ $\text{ii}^{\text{9-8}}_{\text{4-3}}$ Red. $\text{I}^{\text{6-5}}_{\text{4-3}}$ Red. $\text{V}^{\text{7-6}}_{\text{6-5}}$ $\text{I}^{\text{6-5}}$ V^7

Subphrase b - measures 49-52 - Continuation

47

I V⁷ V⁷/IV vii^{°7}/ii ii̇⁶⁻⁸/4-3 I⁴⁻⁴ V⁶⁻⁷

Second Theme

Parallel Period - Measures 53-69

Phrase A - Measures 53-61 - Sentence Form

Subphrase a - measures 53-57 - Sentential Presentation

Subphrase b - measures 57-61 - Continuation

53

p

I[Ab:] V⁷ I vii^{°7}/V I vii^{°7}/V I⁴

Phrase A' - Measures 62-69 - Sentence Form

Subphrase a - measures 62-65 - Sentential Presentation

Subphrase b - measures 65-69 - Continuation

60

IAC

V⁷ I vii^{°7}/V I vii^{°7}/V

First Theme

Parallel Period - measures 70-85

Subphrase b - measures 82-85

Phrase A - measures 70-77 - Sentence Form

Subphrase a - measures 70-73 - Sentential presentation

67

B Section

mf

PAC

I⁴ V⁷ I [Db:] V⁷ I V⁷

Phrase A' - measures 78-85 - Sentence Form

Subphrase a - measures 78-81 - Sentential presentation

Subphrase b - measures 82-85

75

IAC

I V⁷ I V⁶/V V⁷

1.

2.

Second Theme

Parallel Period - measures 86-102

Phrase A - measures 86-94 - Contrasting Period

Subphrase a - measures 86-90 - Antecedent Phrase

Subphrase b - measures 91-94 - Consequent Phrase

84

PAC

ff

p

3

HC?

f

I Ab IV V⁷ I vii^{°7}/V I V⁷

Phrase A' - measures 95-102 - Contrasting Period

Subphrase a - measures 95-98 - Antecedent Phrase

92

3

p

ff

p

3

HC?

I V⁷ I vii^{°7}/V I

First Theme

Parallel Period - measures 103-118

Phrase A - measures 103-110 - Sentence Form

Subphrase a - measures 103-106 - Sentential presentation

Subphrase b - measures 99-102 - Consequent Phrase

99

f

p

mf

IAC

V⁷ I Db V⁷ I

Subphrase b - measures 107-110 - Continuation

Phrase A' - measures 111-118 - Sentence Form

Subphrase a - measures 111-114 - Sentential presentation

Subphrase b - measures 115-118 - Continuation

107

IAC

V⁷ I V⁷ I V⁶/V I⁴

Digression

Parallel Period - measures 119-134

Subphrase b - measures 123-126 - Continuation

Phrase A - measures 119-126 - Sentence Form

Subphrase a - measures 119-122 - Sentential Presentation

117

PAC *f* *ff* *p*

V I V⁷/IV IV V 1.

Subphrase b - measures 131-134 - Continuation

Phrase A' - measures 127-134 - Sentence Form

Subphrase a - measures 127-130 - Sentential Presentation

126

IAC *f* *ff* *p* PAC

I V⁷/IV IV V I

Right Hand Cadenza - Parallel Period - measures 136-151

Phrase A - measures 136-143 - Antecedent Phrase

135

2. *p*

I Bbm: i V⁷ i IV i⁴

Phrase A' - measures 144-151 - Consequent Phrase

141

pp *mp*

V⁷ i V⁷ i

147

cresc.

f *p*

IV *i*₄ V⁷ *i* **Db:** V⁷/IV

Parallel Period - measures 152-167
 Phrase A - measures 152-159 - Sentence Form
 Subphrase a - measures 152-155 - Sentential Presentation

153

mf *f*

HC? IAC

IV V I V⁷/IV

Phrase A' - measures 160-167 - Sentence Form

Subphrase a - measures 160-163 - Sentential Presentation

1. 2.

Subphrase b - measures 164-167 - Continuation

162

ff *p*

HC? PAC

IV V I I **Gb:** I V/V

171

V⁷ I V/V V⁷ I

177

V/V V⁷ I V⁷/V

Motive appears again and brings back A section

183

V⁷ I(Eb): V

A Section

First Theme

Parallel Period - measures 193-208

Phrase A - measures 193-200 - Sentence form

Subphrase a - measures 193-196 - Sentential Presentation

190

Red. V^7 * Red. I * Red. V^7 * $\text{Red. V}^7/\text{IV}$ * $\text{Red. vii}^{\circ 7}/\text{ii}$

Phrase A' - measures 201-208 - Sentence form

Subphrase a - measures 201-204 - Sentential Presentation

Subphrase b - measures 196-200 - Continuation

197

ii⁹⁻⁸₄₋₃ $\text{Red. I}^{6-5}_{4-4}$ * $\text{Red. V}^{7-7}_{6-5}$ * IAC Red. V^7 * Red. I * Red. V^7 * $\text{Red. V}^7/\text{IV}$ * $\text{Red. vii}^{\circ 7}/\text{ii}$

Subphrase b - measures 204-208 - Continuation

Second Theme
Parallel Period - Measures 208-224

Phrase A - Measures 208-216 - Sentence Form
Subphrase a - measures 208-212 - Sentential Presentation

205

mf

p
PAC Motive

$\text{ii}^{\frac{9-8}{6-5}}_4-3$ $\text{V}^{\frac{7-6}{8-7}}_6-5$ I Ab: I

Subphrase b - measures 212-216 - Continuation

Phrase A' - Measures 217-224 - Sentence Form
Subphrase a - measures 217-220 - Sentential Presentation

211

$\text{vii}^{\circ 7}/\text{V}$ I $\text{vii}^{\circ 7}/\text{V}$ $\text{I}^{\frac{6}{4}}$ V^7 I

3

IAC

Subphrase b - measures 220-224 - Continuation

First Theme

Parallel Period - measures 225-241

Phrase A - measures 225-232 - Sentence form
Subphrase a - measures 225-228 - Sentential Presentation

218

$\text{vii}^{\circ 7}/\text{V}$ I $\text{vii}^{\circ 7}/\text{V}$ $\text{I}^{\frac{6}{4}}$ V^7 I

3

PAC

Subphrase b - measures 228-232 - Continuation

225

f *ff* *p* *f*

V^7 I V^7 V^7/IV $\text{vii}^{\circ 7}/\text{ii}$ $\text{ii}^{\frac{9-8}{6-5}}_4-3$ $\text{V}^{\frac{7-6}{8-7}}_6-5$ I^{6-5} V^7

IAC

234

ff *p* *pp*

I V⁷ V⁷/IV vii^{°7}/iii₄₋₃ 14-4 V I

244

Second Theme Material Cadenza Material Second Theme Material

cresc. *pp*

V⁷/V IV

252

Cadenza Material Second Theme Material Cadenza Material

(cresc.) *f*

vii^{°7}

258

(cresc.) *f*

V⁷

263

First Theme Material

ff

I vii^{°7}/V vii^{°7} I V⁷ I V⁷

270

dim.

V^7/IV IV iv I V^7

277

Second Theme Material First Theme Material Second Theme Material

p *pp* *cresc.*

I V^7 I V^7 I V^7

285

Cadenza developed from Second Theme

(*cresc.*) *ff*

$vii^\circ 7/V$

291

f *p* *cresc.*

I

297

(*cresc.*)

I V^7

303

8

(cresc.)

f

ff

311